GET MORE JOB INTERVIEWS IN 14 DAYS

An AI-Assisted Job-Search System for Indian Freshers

A practical system for building a stronger interview pipeline in 14 focused days.

2026 EDITION

TARGET • POSITION • REACH • APPLY • CONVERT

CONTENTS

The 14-day system at a glance

01	FOUNDATION	Pages 2–6
02	BUILD YOUR CANDIDATE ASSET	Pages 7–12
03	APPLICATION & OUTREACH ENGINE	Pages 13–17
04	INTERVIEW CONVERSION	Pages 18–21
05	AI JOB-SEARCH TOOLKIT	Pages 22–30
06	RESUME & PROFILE PLAYBOOK	Pages 31–37
07	INTERVIEW PLAYBOOK	Pages 38–41
08	TRACK, MEASURE & ITERATE	Pages 42–49

Use the chapter dividers to navigate the system. Each day ends with an actionable output.

CHAPTER 01

FOUNDATION

How to Use This Ebook → Day 1

How to Use This Ebook

Read it once. Then execute it like a 14-day sprint.

This book is designed for Indian freshers, recent graduates, career switchers with little relevant experience, and candidates whose applications are not producing enough interview calls.

The objective is not to promise a job in 14 days. The objective is to create a stronger interview pipeline in 14 days by improving five controllable levers: targeting, evidence, discoverability, application quality, and follow-up.

The 14-day rule

- Work on the system every day, even if only for 60–120 focused minutes.
- Track actions and outcomes instead of judging yourself by silence.
- Tailor your materials to a small number of realistic roles rather than sending the same CV everywhere.
- Use AI for research, drafting, critique and practice—not for inventing qualifications.
- Keep your own voice. Every claim on your resume and profile must be true and defensible.

The fastest improvement usually comes from reducing randomness: fewer role types, clearer proof, better keyword alignment, stronger outreach, and faster learning from response data.

The Interview Pipeline

Think like a funnel, not a lottery.

The five-stage pipeline

Stage	What you control	Typical failure
1. Targeting	Role family, location, level	Applying to unrelated roles
2. Positioning	Headline, resume, proof	Generic candidate story
3. Discoverability	Profiles, keywords, networks	Recruiters cannot find you
4. Application	Tailoring, timing, follow-up	Mass applying with one CV
5. Conversion	Interview preparation, communication	Getting calls but losing momentum

The key idea

An interview is an intermediate outcome. Your 14-day goal is to increase the number of credible conversations with employers. Measure leading indicators—qualified applications, recruiter messages, referrals requested, profile improvements, responses—not only final offers.

A useful weekly scorecard: targeted applications sent + relevant people contacted + replies received + interviews scheduled + interviews completed.

What the 2026 Indian Market Suggests

Use market data to choose where to spend your effort—not to chase hype.

Recent Naukri JobSpeak releases show continued entry-level hiring activity in India during 2026. Fresher hiring was reported up 15% year over year in August 2026; it was also up 16% in March and 17% in February. These are aggregate market indicators, not guarantees for any individual candidate.

The same reports show that hiring momentum is not limited to traditional IT. In 2026, Naukri reported strong activity in sectors such as insurance, BPO/ITES, healthcare, hospitality, retail, manufacturing/engineering and other non-IT areas, while AI/ML hiring remained particularly strong.

What this means for a fresher

- Do not define 'fresher jobs' as only software developer roles.
- Search by job family and transferable skills: operations, customer success, sales, finance operations, HR, recruitment, support, content, analytics, QA, administration and technical roles.
- Look beyond a single metro. Emerging cities and non-metro hiring can create additional search space.
- Treat AI literacy as a supporting skill rather than a substitute for role-specific ability.

Research note: market conditions change quickly. Re-check current job counts, salaries and role requirements before making major career decisions.

Your 14-Day Operating System

A simple loop: Research → Build → Reach → Apply → Follow up → Learn.

Day	Primary objective	Core output
1	Choose target	1 role family + 30 target employers
2	Build evidence	Skills/proof inventory + gap map
3	Rebuild resume	ATS-readable master resume
4	Tailor system	2–3 role-specific resume variants
5	Profile	LinkedIn + Naukri positioning
6	Proof	Portfolio/project/proof assets
7	Network	30-person outreach list
8	Apply	First targeted application batch
9	Outreach	Referral + recruiter messages
10	Search expansion	Hidden/adjacent opportunities
11	Interview prep	Stories + role questions
12	Mock interviews	Practice + feedback
13	Follow-up	Application and interview follow-ups
14	Optimize	Review data + next 14-day cycle

Do not restart the system every time you feel discouraged. Day 14 is not the end; it is the point where you have enough data to make your next cycle smarter.

Day 1 — Pick a Job You Can Actually Target

Your first job-search advantage is specificity.

Choose one primary role family

Write one sentence: “For the next 14 days, I am targeting [ROLE FAMILY] roles at [LEVEL] in [LOCATIONS/REMOTE].” Examples: Customer Support Associate, HR Recruiter, Business Development Executive, Junior Data Analyst, Accounts Executive, Operations Executive, Content Executive, QA Tester.

Use the 70/20/10 rule

- 70% of applications: roles that closely match your current evidence.
- 20%: adjacent roles where your skills transfer.
- 10%: stretch roles where you meet most but not all requirements.

Build a target-company list

1. Find 30 companies that hire your target role.
2. Mark each company A, B or C based on role fit and accessibility—not prestige.
3. Record the careers page, relevant LinkedIn page, location, role titles and any people you can contact.
4. Identify 3–5 recurring keywords across their job descriptions.

AI prompt: “Here are 10 job descriptions for entry-level [ROLE]. Extract the recurring responsibilities, tools, skills, qualifications and outcome verbs. Group them into must-have, common and differentiating requirements. Do not invent requirements.”

CHAPTER 02

BUILD YOUR CANDIDATE ASSET

Day 2 → Day 7

Day 2 — Build Your Evidence Inventory

Freshers often have more evidence than they think.

Your experience is bigger than paid employment

For entry-level applications, relevant evidence can come from internships, college projects, freelance work, volunteering, competitions, student organisations, certifications, part-time work, family business support, research, presentations, event management and self-directed projects. The evidence must be genuine and relevant.

Evidence source	What to extract
College project	Problem, your contribution, tools, output
Internship	Tasks, volume, tools, outcomes
Volunteer work	Responsibility, people, result
Academic work	Analysis, writing, research, presentation
Part-time work	Customer, sales, operations or process evidence
Self-project	Problem, method, artifact, result

Turn activity into evidence

Weak: “Made a college project on sales.” Stronger: “Analysed 120 survey responses in Excel and presented three customer-segment findings to a four-member project team.” The second version gives a recruiter something concrete to discuss.

Never manufacture numbers. If you do not know an exact figure, use an honest qualitative description or a range you can defend.

Day 3 — Build the Master Resume

One strong master resume becomes the source for tailored versions.

Recommended fresher structure

1. Name + contact details + professional links
2. Targeted headline / summary
3. Skills
4. Education
5. Projects / internships / experience
6. Certifications
7. Leadership / volunteering / achievements where relevant

For many freshers, one page is enough. The goal is not to fill a page; it is to make relevant evidence easy to find. A clean, readable structure also reduces friction when a recruiter or application system processes the document.

Indeed's current guidance emphasizes clear formatting, relevant keywords, truthful claims and tailoring the resume to the role. It also notes that ATS tools may sort applications using job-related keywords.

Master resume vs tailored resume

Keep a master document containing your full truthful inventory. Before applying, create a tailored copy that changes the summary, skills emphasis and order of evidence to match the specific vacancy.

Day 4 — The Keyword Alignment System

Match the job language without stuffing or copying blindly.

The three buckets

Bucket	Examples	Action
Hard skills	Excel, SQL, Canva, Tally, Python	Include only if you can demonstrate them
Role skills	Lead generation, reconciliation, sourcing	Mirror relevant wording
Outcome language	improved, analysed, resolved, coordinated	Use truthful action + result language

LinkedIn says recruiter search can use explicit skills in a profile and implicit skills extracted from profile text such as summaries, titles and descriptions. That makes consistent, natural language important across your profile—not just a keyword list.

Indeed likewise recommends using relevant keywords from the job description while keeping them accurate.

The alignment test

- Can I honestly claim this skill?
- Is the skill actually relevant to the vacancy?
- Does my resume contain evidence of using it?
- Does the same idea appear naturally in my profile?
- Have I avoided repeating the same keyword in every line?

Never add a skill solely because an ATS may look for it. Keyword matching is useful only when the underlying capability is real.

Day 5 — Fix LinkedIn and Naukri Discoverability

Your profile should answer: “What can this person do for this role?”

LinkedIn headline formula

[Target role] | [2–4 relevant skills] | [proof/industry/project]

Example: “Entry-Level Operations Executive | Excel • Process Coordination • Customer Support | Business Administration Graduate”

About section formula

1. Who you are and the role you target.
2. 2–3 capabilities supported by evidence.
3. One or two proof points from projects, internships or work.
4. What kind of opportunity you are looking for.
5. A simple invitation to connect.

LinkedIn's job-search guidance recommends having a strong profile that showcases skills and expertise. LinkedIn's recruiter documentation also indicates that profile text can contribute to skills matching.

Naukri states that completed and updated profiles have higher chances of recruiter contact, and recruiters can search its resume database using keywords, designations and companies.

Do not paste your entire resume into your About section. Make the profile searchable and human-readable.

Day 6 — Create Proof Before You Need It

A fresher's strongest answer to “You have no experience” is evidence of doing the work.

Build one proof asset

- Business/marketing: a one-page competitor or customer analysis.
- Data: a cleaned spreadsheet + dashboard + short insight memo.
- HR: a sample sourcing plan + candidate tracker.
- Content: three original posts + a content calendar.
- Operations: a process map + improvement proposal.
- Finance: a simple financial analysis using public data.
- Tech: a small project with README, screenshots and a live/demo link where appropriate.

The proof-asset formula

Problem → Approach → Tool → Output → What you learned. Keep it small enough to finish in one or two days. The goal is conversation fuel, not a massive portfolio.

AI can help you brainstorm project ideas, create a project brief, critique your output and generate test cases. You should perform and understand the work yourself.

Day 7 — Build Your 30-Person Network List

Networking is not asking strangers for jobs. It is creating relevant professional conversations.

Who belongs on the list?

- Alumni from your college/university.
- People currently doing your target job.
- Recruiters who hire for your target function.
- Former interns or junior employees at target companies.
- Professional contacts from internships, projects or volunteering.

Record five fields

Person	Why relevant	Shared context	Ask	Status
Name	Role/company	College/location/skill	15-min advice	Not contacted
Name	Recruiter	Target role	Role fit question	Messaged
Name	Employee	Same function	Learning question	Replied

Your first message should be short and specific. Do not attach a resume immediately unless appropriate. The first goal is a reply, not a referral.

CHAPTER 03

APPLICATION & OUTREACH ENGINE

Day 8 → Day 10

Day 8 — Send Your First Targeted Application Batch

Quality control before quantity.

The 10-minute application protocol

1. Read the entire job description once.
2. Underline must-have requirements and recurring terms.
3. Select the most relevant resume version.
4. Rewrite the top summary in the language of the role.
5. Move the strongest relevant evidence upward.
6. Check location, experience level, salary expectations and eligibility.
7. Apply through the requested channel.
8. Record the application immediately.

Application tracker fields

Date | Company | Role | Source | Resume version | Contact | Status | Follow-up date | Interview stage | Notes

A job application that you cannot later remember is not a useful data point. Tracking turns your search into a learning system.

Day 9 — Direct Outreach That Gets Replies

Make your message easy to answer.

The 4-line outreach structure

1. Context: why you are contacting them. 2. Relevance: the role/function you share. 3. Specific question: one easy-to-answer question. 4. Appreciation: no pressure.

Example

“Hi Priya, I’m a recent B.Com graduate targeting entry-level finance operations roles. I noticed you work in finance operations at ABC and I’m trying to understand what skills matter most in the first six months. If you have a minute, which two skills would you prioritise? Thanks.”

After a useful reply

Respond to the person's answer first. Only then, if appropriate, mention a relevant opening and ask whether they would be comfortable sharing any advice on the application.

Do not send the same mass message to 100 people. Generic outreach is easy to ignore and can damage your professional impression.

Day 10 — Expand the Search Without Losing Focus

Broaden the market, not your identity.

Use adjacent titles

Primary role	Adjacent titles to test
Customer Support	Customer Success Associate, Support Executive, Client Service Associate
HR	HR Recruiter, Talent Acquisition Associate, HR Operations Executive
Sales	Business Development Executive, Inside Sales Associate, Sales Executive
Data	MIS Executive, Reporting Analyst, Junior Data Analyst
Finance	Accounts Executive, Finance Operations Associate, Reconciliation Executive
Operations	Operations Executive, Process Associate, Coordinator

Search in three dimensions

- Title: what the job is called.
- Skill: what the job needs you to do.
- Industry: where the skill is applied.

LinkedIn's current AI-powered job search allows natural-language descriptions of the role, location, experience level, skills and other preferences, which can help candidates explore adjacent opportunities more efficiently.

Day 11 — Build Your Interview Story Bank

Do not memorise answers. Prepare evidence.

Create eight stories

- A difficult problem you solved.
- A time you worked with others.
- A time you made a mistake and corrected it.
- A time you learned something quickly.
- A project you are proud of.
- A conflict or disagreement you handled.
- A time you took initiative.
- A time you managed pressure or competing priorities.

Use STAR

Situation: set the context. Task: explain your responsibility. Action: explain what you actually did. Result: show the outcome and what you learned.

Indeed's interview guidance describes STAR as a way to prepare clear responses to behavioural questions, with the answer grounded in a specific situation, task, action and result.

For a fresher, a STAR story can come from college, an internship, volunteering, a project, part-time work or another genuine experience. The point is the behaviour and evidence, not the prestige of the setting.

Day 12 — Run Two Mock Interviews

Practice is a feedback loop, not a performance.

Mock interview 1: role fit

1. Tell me about yourself.
2. Why this role?
3. Why this company?
4. What relevant skills do you have?
5. Walk me through your strongest project.
6. What would you need to learn quickly?

Mock interview 2: behavioural

1. Tell me about a difficult problem.
2. Tell me about a mistake.
3. Tell me about teamwork.
4. Tell me about a time you showed initiative.
5. How do you handle deadlines?
6. Tell me about a time you received criticism.

Record yourself if you can. Score only observable behaviours: clarity, concision, evidence, structure, confidence, listening and relevance. Do not obsess over accent or perfect grammar.

CHAPTER 04

INTERVIEW CONVERSION

Day 11 → Day 14

Day 13 — Follow Up Professionally

A follow-up is a reminder, not pressure.

Application follow-up

If a job posting or recruiter gave a follow-up timeline, respect it. If no timeline exists, one concise follow-up after a reasonable interval is generally enough. Keep the message short and include the role title.

Interview follow-up

Thank the interviewer, mention one specific part of the conversation, and reinforce your interest. Avoid sending multiple messages in quick succession.

Track outcomes

Outcome	What it tells you	Next action
No response	Unknown / low signal	Keep pipeline moving
Rejected before interview	Positioning/fit issue possible	Compare requirements
Recruiter reply	Message/profile worked	Continue conversation
Interview scheduled	Application converted	Prepare intensely
Interview rejected	Conversion issue	Request feedback if appropriate

Do not interpret one rejection as a verdict on your career. Treat it as one data point in a noisy process.

Day 14 — Review the Data and Restart Smarter

Your second 14-day cycle should be more intelligent than the first.

Calculate five numbers

- Targeted applications sent.
- Direct contacts made.
- Replies received.
- Interviews scheduled.
- Interviews completed.

Diagnose the bottleneck

If this is low…	Inspect…
Applications sent	Time, search strategy, role criteria
Replies	Profile, outreach relevance, targeting
Interviews from applications	Resume alignment, job fit, application quality
Interviews from referrals	Outreach quality, role fit
Interview-to-next-stage	Preparation, communication, role knowledge

The goal is not to feel productive. The goal is to find the stage where the pipeline is leaking and improve that stage in the next cycle.

The AI-Assisted Job Search: Rules

AI is your research and drafting assistant—not your identity.

Use AI for

- Extracting recurring requirements from multiple job descriptions.
- Comparing your evidence to a job description.
- Drafting alternative resume bullets from facts you provide.
- Generating interview questions from a vacancy.
- Running mock interviews.
- Finding gaps in a project explanation.
- Improving clarity, grammar and structure.

Do not use AI to

- Invent employment, internships, achievements, certifications or metrics.
- Claim proficiency in tools you cannot use.
- Write fake stories for behavioural interviews.
- Misrepresent your degree, grades or eligibility.
- Spam recruiters with automated messages.

The credibility test: if an interviewer asks, “How did you do this?” you should be able to explain the work yourself.

AI Prompt 1 — Job Description Decoder

Turn a vacancy into a practical checklist.

Copy the job description into your AI tool and use this prompt:

“Analyse this job description for an entry-level candidate. Extract: (1) job title, (2) top responsibilities, (3) must-have skills, (4) preferred skills, (5) tools/software, (6) recurring keywords, (7) evidence a strong fresher could show, (8) likely interview topics. Separate explicit requirements from reasonable inferences. Do not invent information.”

Then ask

“Now create a 10-point application checklist. Rank each requirement as Essential, Important or Nice-to-have based only on the job description.”

Why this works

It converts a long vacancy into a decision document. You still make the final judgement about whether you genuinely meet the requirements.

CHAPTER 05

AI JOB-SEARCH TOOLKIT

AI Rules → Outreach Personalisation

AI Prompt 2 — Resume Gap Analysis

Ask the AI to critique, not flatter you.

Use this prompt after providing your resume and a job description:

“Compare my resume with this job description. Create four sections: MATCHED EVIDENCE, PARTIAL MATCHES, MISSING BUT TRAINABLE, and MISSING/NOT CLAIMABLE. Quote the relevant evidence from my resume for every matched item. Identify the five highest-impact changes I can make without inventing experience.”

Second pass

“Rewrite only the summary and the five most relevant resume bullets using my existing facts. Keep every claim truthful. Do not add metrics unless I supplied them.”

This approach keeps AI grounded in your actual evidence. It also prevents the common mistake of accepting impressive-sounding text that you cannot defend in an interview.

AI Prompt 3 — Resume Bullet Builder

Transform tasks into evidence-based bullets.

Use:

“I will give you a real task I performed. Ask me up to three questions needed to make the bullet specific. Then produce three versions: concise ATS-friendly, achievement-oriented, and simple human-readable. Do not invent numbers, tools, outcomes or responsibilities.”

Example input

“I handled customer queries during my internship.”

Useful follow-up questions

- What type of queries?
- How did you handle them?
- Which tool or channel did you use?
- How frequently did you do it?
- What happened as a result?

A good bullet emerges from facts. AI should help you surface those facts rather than manufacture them.

AI Prompt 4 — LinkedIn & Naukri Profile Optimizer

Make the same professional identity consistent across platforms.

Prompt:

“Using only the facts in my resume and target job description, create: (1) LinkedIn headline under 220 characters, (2) LinkedIn About section under 1,500 characters, (3) Naukri profile headline, (4) 30 relevant skills, and (5) three recruiter-search keyword clusters. Avoid generic claims such as ‘hardworking’ unless supported by evidence.”

Human check

- Does it sound like something you would actually say?
- Can you explain every skill listed?
- Does your target role appear clearly?
- Are the strongest relevant skills near the top?
- Are there contradictions between profile and resume?

LinkedIn documents both explicit skills and skills inferred from profile text, so consistency across the profile can help your professional story remain discoverable.

AI Prompt 5 — Find Better Search Queries

Stop searching only the exact job title.

Prompt:

“My target role is [ROLE]. My strongest skills are [SKILLS]. My preferred locations are [LOCATIONS]. Generate 25 job-search queries grouped into: exact titles, adjacent titles, skill-led searches, industry-led searches and location combinations. Keep them realistic for entry-level hiring in India.”

Search matrix

Dimension	Example
Title	Operations Executive
Skill	Excel operations entry level
Industry	Operations in healthcare
Location	Operations Executive Pune
Combined	Entry-level operations Excel Hyderabad

LinkedIn's current job-search system supports natural-language intent and can match searches against job descriptions, making descriptive queries useful alongside traditional title searches.

AI Prompt 6 — Company Research in 10 Minutes

Know enough to ask intelligent questions.

Prompt:

“Research this company using only publicly available information I provide or clearly identified sources. Summarise: business model, main products/services, target customers, recent developments, likely skills for [ROLE], and three intelligent questions I can ask in an interview. Separate verified facts from interpretation.”

Your research sheet

- What does the company sell or provide?
- Who is the customer?
- What does this role actually do?
- What business problem does the role support?
- What recent development might affect the team?
- What can I ask that demonstrates genuine curiosity?

Do not memorise company trivia. Connect the company's work to the job you are applying for.

AI Prompt 7 — Mock Interviewer

Practice the questions you are most likely to face.

Prompt:

“Act as a realistic interviewer for an entry-level [ROLE] in India. Ask one question at a time. Mix role-specific, behavioural and motivation questions. Do not give me the answer before I respond. After each answer, give feedback on relevance, clarity, evidence, structure and concision. Then ask the next question.”

Advanced version

“After 10 questions, identify my three strongest answers, three weakest answers, repeated filler phrases, missing evidence and five specific improvements for my next interview.”

Use the mock interview to improve your thinking, not to memorise artificial language.

AI Prompt 8 — Build STAR Stories

Turn real experiences into interview-ready evidence.

Prompt:

“Here is a real experience from my college/internship/project: [PASTE FACTS]. Ask me questions until you have enough information to structure it as Situation, Task, Action and Result. Do not invent facts. Produce a 60-second version and a 120-second version, plus three follow-up questions an interviewer might ask.”

Why two versions?

A 60-second answer helps when the interviewer wants a concise example. A 120-second version helps when the story contains meaningful context or technical detail.

STAR is particularly useful for behavioural questions because it forces you to explain what happened and what you personally did, rather than only describing the group project or team.

AI Prompt 9 — Outreach Personalisation

Personalise from real context, not fake familiarity.

Prompt:

“Here is a public professional profile summary and a target job description. Draft a 70-word LinkedIn message that mentions one genuine point of relevance, asks one specific low-effort question, and avoids asking for a job or referral in the first message. Do not imply that I know the person personally.”

Good personalisation

- Same college or course.
- Same functional area.
- Same industry interest.
- A public post they wrote that is genuinely relevant.
- A role transition you want to understand.

Never use AI to fabricate personal details, shared interests or admiration. People can tell.

The One-Page Resume Blueprint

A practical structure for many entry-level candidates.

Section	What belongs here	Typical space
Header	Name, phone, email, professional links	10%
Summary	Target role + strongest relevant evidence	10%
Skills	6–12 relevant, defensible skills	10%
Experience/Projects	3–6 evidence-rich bullets per major item	45%
Education	Degree, institution, graduation	15%
Other	Certifications, leadership, achievements	10%

Formatting rules

- Use a readable standard font.
- Use consistent dates and headings.
- Avoid decorative graphics that hide information.
- Use bullets rather than dense paragraphs.
- Proofread names, dates, links and contact details.
- Export to PDF unless the employer requests another format.

Indeed's current ATS guidance recommends a structure that makes relevant keywords and information easy for application systems and recruiters to identify.

CHAPTER 06

RESUME & PROFILE PLAYBOOK

Resume Blueprint → LinkedIn Strategy

Resume Bullet Formula

Specific beats impressive-sounding.

Formula A: Action + task + context + result

“Analysed customer survey responses in Excel to identify recurring service issues, then presented three improvement recommendations to the project team.”

Formula B: Action + volume + tool

“Coordinated weekly event registrations for 150+ participants using Google Sheets and structured follow-up messages.”

Formula C: Problem + action + outcome

“Reduced duplicate entries in a project dataset by standardising fields and validating records before analysis.”

Avoid

- Responsible for…
- Worked on…
- Helped with…
- Hardworking and sincere…
- Excellent communication skills…

These phrases are not forbidden, but they are weak when they appear without evidence. Show the behaviour through the work you performed.

Skills: What to List and What to Prove

A skills section is a promise. Your experience section should support it.

Three levels of skill

Level	Meaning	Example
Working knowledge	Can perform common tasks with some guidance	Excel: sorting, filters, basic formulas
Proficient	Can complete typical tasks independently	Excel: pivots, lookups, dashboards
Advanced	Can handle complex use cases and explain trade-offs	SQL: joins, aggregation, data validation

For a fresher, it is usually better to list fewer relevant skills you can demonstrate than a long list of tools you touched once.

Proof test

For every listed skill, prepare one answer to: “Where have you used it?” If you cannot answer with a concrete example, reconsider the skill level or remove it.

Portfolio for Non-Technical Freshers

You do not need a software portfolio to show proof.

Portfolio examples

- HR: sourcing funnel, interview scorecard, onboarding checklist.
- Sales: lead list methodology, outreach sequence, sales analysis.
- Marketing: campaign brief, audience analysis, content calendar.
- Finance: ratio analysis, expense dashboard, reconciliation sample.
- Operations: SOP, process map, issue log, improvement proposal.
- Customer support: FAQ redesign, ticket categorisation, response templates.
- Administration: event plan, tracker, document-control workflow.

Keep it employer-friendly

One problem. One artifact. One page of explanation. One link. If the project is based on public information, cite the source. If it uses personal or confidential information, replace it with synthetic or public data.

Your project should demonstrate judgement and execution. A polished template without substance is weaker than a simple artifact that clearly shows how you think.

Naukri Strategy

Treat your profile as a searchable professional asset.

Naukri's own explanation of its platform says recruiters search profiles and that completed, updated profiles have higher chances of being contacted. It also describes job recommendations based on profile data and previous applications.

Naukri checklist

- Target role appears clearly in the headline.
- Relevant skills are complete and accurate.
- Resume is current.
- Education and location are accurate.
- Employment preferences are realistic.
- Notice period / availability information is accurate.
- Profile is updated when your skills or project evidence changes.

Weekly maintenance

Spend 15 minutes each week reviewing profile completeness, new relevant skills, current target roles and recent applications. Do not change everything every day.

LinkedIn Strategy

Become easier to understand and easier to find.

Profile checklist

- Professional photo with clear visibility.
- Specific headline tied to target role.
- About section written in first person.
- Skills aligned to the target role.
- Projects and internships described with evidence.
- Education complete.
- Relevant certifications linked or described.
- Location and preferences accurate.

Content: optional, not mandatory

You do not need to become a content creator to get hired. If you post, share useful evidence: a project insight, a short lesson from your learning, a case analysis, or a thoughtful explanation of a relevant concept.

LinkedIn's job-search guidance encourages candidates to maintain a profile that showcases their skills and expertise.

Job Boards: A Balanced Portfolio

No single platform should carry your entire search.

Channel	Use it for	Risk
Naukri	Broad Indian recruiter market	Mass-applying
LinkedIn	Discovery + networking + jobs	Scrolling without outreach
Indeed	Job search + employer research	Applying without tailoring
Company careers	Direct openings	Missing hidden roles
Alumni networks	Warm conversations	Asking too quickly
NCS	Government-supported employment services	Using it passively

India's National Career Service is a government employment-service platform. Use official government resources to check job-search services, career centres and related support where relevant.

The rule

Use job boards for discovery, company pages for verification, and people for context.

Interview: The First 90 Seconds

Your opening should be relevant, structured and calm.

“Tell me about yourself” formula

1. Present: who you are and what you are targeting.
2. Proof: one or two relevant projects/experiences.
3. Fit: why this role is the logical next step.

Example structure: “I’m a recent graduate in [field] focused on entry-level [role]. During my studies, I worked on [project] where I used [skill] to [result]. I also gained exposure to [relevant area]. I’m now looking for a role where I can apply those skills while developing deeper experience in [function].”

Avoid

- Starting with your entire life story.
- Repeating every line of the resume.
- Apologising for being a fresher.
- Making claims you cannot support.
- Speaking for several minutes without connecting to the role.

CHAPTER 07

INTERVIEW PLAYBOOK

Interview: First 90 Seconds → Preparation

Interview: “Why Should We Hire You?”

Translate your strengths into role-relevant evidence.

Use the three-part answer

Relevant capability + proof + learning attitude.

Example: “For this role, I think my strongest fit is organised follow-through and Excel-based reporting. In my final project, I maintained the dataset, cleaned the entries and created the summary analysis. I know I still have a lot to learn about your internal systems, but I’m comfortable learning tools quickly and working carefully with structured information.”

The fresher advantage—without pretending

- Show evidence of learning quickly.
- Show that you understand the role.
- Show willingness to do the fundamentals well.
- Show curiosity and preparation.
- Do not claim that you are the perfect candidate.

Indeed's current fresher interview guidance emphasizes preparing relevant examples and using STAR-style responses for behavioural questions.

Interview: Questions You Should Ask

Good questions help you understand the role and demonstrate preparation.

Ask about the work

- What would you want the person in this role to accomplish in the first 90 days?
- What are the most common tasks in a typical week?
- Which skills separate a strong performer from an average one?
- What would the first few weeks of training look like?

Ask about the team

- Who would I work with most closely?
- How is work typically assigned and reviewed?
- What is the biggest challenge the team is solving right now?

Close well

If appropriate: “Is there anything about my background that you would like me to clarify?” This gives you a chance to address a misunderstanding before the conversation ends.

Interview Preparation in 30 Minutes

A repeatable pre-interview routine.

Minutes	Task
0–5	Read the job description again
5–10	Review your top 5 matching skills/evidence
10–15	Research company + role
15–20	Practice Tell Me About Yourself + Why role
20–25	Review 3 STAR stories
25–30	Prepare 3 questions + check logistics

The night before

- Test internet, camera, microphone and meeting link.
- Keep resume and job description accessible.
- Prepare a quiet, well-lit environment.
- Choose professional clothing.
- Sleep instead of cramming until very late.

Preparation should reduce uncertainty, not create another source of stress.

Application Tracker — Master Template

Copy this structure into a spreadsheet or notebook.

Date	Company	Role	Source	Resume	Contact	Status

Add these fields if useful

JD link | salary shown | location | eligibility | follow-up date | interview date | interviewer | outcome | reason/feedback | next action

The tracker is not administrative busywork. It prevents duplicate applications, makes follow-up timely and reveals which channels actually produce conversations.

CHAPTER 08

TRACK, MEASURE & ITERATE

Tracker → The Next 14 Days

Daily Scorecard

Measure controllable behaviour for 14 days.

Metric	Target	Actual
Focused job-search time	60–120 min/day	
Targeted applications	3–8/day	
Relevant outreach	3–5/day	
Profile / resume improvement	1 concrete improvement/day	
Interview practice	15–30 min/day from Day 7	
Follow-ups	As scheduled	

Quality check

- Did I apply only to roles I can reasonably explain?
- Did I tailor the top of my resume?
- Did I record the application?
- Did I contact at least a few relevant people?
- Did I spend some time improving interview readiness?

Targets are operating guidelines, not promises of a specific number of interviews. Adjust them for your schedule, role and market.

Common Failure Modes

Fix the system, not your self-worth.

Failure	Why it hurts	Better approach
100 generic applications	Low relevance + no learning	10–30 targeted applications
One resume for everything	Weak role alignment	Create 2–3 role variants
Only Easy Apply	Limited relationship building	Combine applications + outreach
Listing every skill	Diluted positioning	List relevant defensible skills
AI-written fake achievements	Credibility risk	AI drafts only from your facts
Waiting after applying	Pipeline becomes empty	Continue searching + follow up
Ignoring non-IT roles	Smaller opportunity set	Search adjacent sectors

A strong system is not about doing everything. It is about doing a few high-value actions repeatedly and learning from the results.

A 14-Day Calendar You Can Print

Use one row per day.

Day	Main task	Done
1	Target role + 30 employers	☐
2	Evidence inventory	☐
3	Master resume	☐
4	Keyword + tailored variants	☐
5	LinkedIn + Naukri	☐
6	Proof asset	☐
7	30-person network list	☐
8	Targeted application batch	☐
9	Direct outreach	☐
10	Adjacent-role search	☐
11	STAR story bank	☐
12	Two mock interviews	☐
13	Follow-ups	☐
14	Pipeline review + next cycle	☐

If you miss a day, do not abandon the plan. Move the task to the next available slot and continue.

The 14-Day Job Search Script Pack

Ready-to-adapt language for real situations.

Connection message

“Hi [Name], I’m a recent [degree] graduate targeting entry-level [role] positions. I came across your profile because of your work in [function]. I’m trying to understand which skills matter most for someone starting in this area. If you have a minute, I’d really value one piece of advice.”

Referral conversation

“Thanks for the guidance. I found this [role] opening at [company], and the responsibilities seem closely aligned with my [project/skill]. If you think my background is relevant, would you be comfortable suggesting how I should approach the application?”

Follow-up

“Hi [Name], just following up on my application for the [Role] position. I remain very interested in the opportunity and would be happy to provide any additional information. Thank you for your time.”

Adapt the wording to the relationship and context. Do not send a message you would not naturally say yourself.

Your Personal Job-Search Dashboard

Create a single page that keeps the system visible.

Area	This 14-day target	Current
Target role	1 primary + 2 adjacent	
Target companies	30+	
Resume variants	2–3	
Proof assets	1–2	
Relevant contacts	30	
Applications	Your sustainable daily quota	
Interviews	Track actual, never guarantee	
STAR stories	8	

Weekly review questions

1. Where did I get the most replies?
2. Which roles are repeatedly rejecting me before interview?
3. Which skills appear again and again?
4. What evidence do I lack?
5. Which outreach messages produce conversations?
6. What should I stop doing next week?

Research Notes & Sources

Selected sources used to ground the framework.

Current Indian hiring indicators

Naukri JobSpeak, 2026 releases: fresher hiring and sector-level hiring trends. August 2026 reported 15% year-over-year fresher hiring growth; March 2026 reported 16%; February 2026 reported 17%. These are aggregate market indicators, not individual probabilities.

Skills and employability

Mercer | Mettl, India Graduate Skill Index 2025: analysis of graduate readiness and skills across 2,700+ campuses and more than 1 million students; the report highlights the growing importance of soft skills and AI-related readiness.

World Economic Forum, Future of Jobs Report 2025: employer perspectives on labour-market transformation, technology and skills through 2030.

Resume, profile and interview guidance

Indeed India Career Guide: ATS-friendly resumes, keyword use, first-job resumes, STAR interviewing and fresher interview preparation.

LinkedIn Help: job search, AI-powered job search and recruiter skills matching.

Naukri: how its job-search process works and how recruiters use its resume database.

All market statistics in this ebook are time-sensitive. Re-check the original source before using any figure in public content, training or commercial materials.

The Next 14 Days

The real advantage comes from iteration.

If the system worked

You now have a defined role target, a stronger resume, searchable profiles, proof of skills, a network list, a tracker, outreach scripts and an interview story bank. That is a reusable job-search infrastructure—not a one-time application burst.

If the system did not work yet

Do not immediately conclude that you are unemployable or that the market is impossible. Find the bottleneck. If you received no responses, inspect targeting and discoverability. If you received recruiter responses but no interviews, inspect resume alignment. If you interviewed but did not advance, inspect role knowledge, communication and evidence. Then run another 14-day cycle.

Your job search becomes powerful when every rejection, silence, reply and interview teaches the next application something.

Final checklist

- I know exactly which role family I am targeting.
- My resume is truthful, readable and role-aligned.
- My LinkedIn and Naukri profiles tell the same professional story.
- I can show proof of at least one relevant skill.
- I have a list of people I can contact professionally.
- I track every meaningful application.
- I have eight STAR stories.
- I practise instead of memorising.
- I use AI to improve my work—not to fake qualifications.
- I can run the system again without starting from zero.

Start tomorrow with Day 1. The objective is not perfection. It is a better pipeline after 14 focused days.